

Field Placement Guide: Supervised K-12 Delivery for the Hackles College Course

The Hackles Kit

Trust your hackles. Pause · Check · Tell.

FIELD COPY

1



Lock It

PASSWORDS AND ACCOUNTS

2



Spot It

SCAMS AND FAKES

3



Share Smart

PRIVACY

4



Safe People

WHO TO TRUST

5



Kind and Well

KINDNESS AND BALANCE

6



Fix It

TELL, REPAIR, RECOVER

PLATE I. The six strands, hand-in-ked, in the order the lessons take them.

A free kit by Competence Collective · competencecollective.org

© 2026 Competence Collective. Lesson text and teaching materials: CC BY-NC 4.0 (free to print, share and adapt for non-commercial use with credit). The Hackles name, logos, characters and artwork are not covered by that license: print and share them unaltered for classroom and family use; any other use needs written permission. [VERIFY with counsel]



OCTOBER 2026

© 2026 Competence Collective. Lesson text and teaching materials CC BY-NC 4.0. The Hackles name, logos, characters and artwork are not covered by that license: print and share them unaltered for classroom and family use; any other use needs written permission. [VERIFY with counsel]

For candidates, mentor teachers, school administrators and the college field office. This guide is educational guidance, not legal advice. Placement rules differ by state, district and program. Where this guide and your district's policy or your state's program-approval rules differ, follow the policy and tell the field office. Hackles has not been reviewed or approved by any state education agency, and field hours in this course may or may not count toward licensure requirements [VERIFY with your state program approval and field office].

No student accounts, no student data collected, ever.

01 What the field experience is for

TEACHING A SKILL IS different from reading about it. In the field you will watch how a classroom works, deliver two short, standard-care Hackles lessons with a mentor teacher in the room, and run a workshop for adults. You will also practice the daily habits of a trusted adult: calm language, privacy, and knowing your reporting route.

Minimum: 12 on-site hours over the term:

ACTIVITY	HOURS (ABOUT)	WEEKS
Orientation, paperwork, meeting your mentor	1.5	1 to 3
Observation 1: how a teacher talks with students about technology	1.5	4
Observation 2: score a lesson with the Fun, Safe, Skill-based rubric	1.5	5
Co-planning with the mentor teacher	1.5	6 to 10
Supervised lesson 1 (planning, delivery, debrief)	2	10 to 12
Supervised lesson 2 (planning, delivery, debrief)	2	12 to 13
Capstone workshop for adults (site time)	1.5	14 to 15

In-service teachers use their own classroom. You still need an administrator's written approval, a colleague or counselor who knows your lesson dates, and the same privacy and safety rules.

02 Before any contact with students

COMPLETE THESE BEFORE YOU set foot in a classroom as a candidate. Start in Week 1; background checks can take weeks.

REQUIREMENT	WHO	NOTES
Background check (and fingerprinting where required)	Candidate and field office	Required by the district and often the state [VERIFY your state and district rules]. No contact with students until cleared
Mandated-reporter orientation	District or school, plus this course in Week 8	Many districts require staff and volunteers to complete training and sign an acknowledgment. Ask the school which version applies to candidates [VERIFY]
Placement agreement between the college and the school	Field office and school administrator	Names the mentor teacher, the dates, the supervision rules and who handles incidents
Mentor teacher agreement	Mentor teacher	Describes the mentor's role (Section 7)
Confidentiality and privacy acknowledgment	Candidate	Covers the no-student-data rule in Section 4
Liability and insurance information	Field office	[INSTITUTION to specify; VERIFY with your risk office]
Counselor aware	Mentor teacher	The school counselor knows who you are, the lesson dates and the topics, and agrees to be available
Response Readiness gate (for delivery only)	Candidate and instructor	Practicum standard met and Contact Card and Reporting Map verified with a school administrator or counselor

03 Mandated-reporting orientation for candidates

IN THE UNITED STATES every state and the District of Columbia has laws requiring certain people to report suspected child abuse and neglect. School staff are named as mandated reporters in about 44 states and DC, and several states make every adult a reporter; whether a candidate or volunteer is covered depends on the state and the district [VERIFIED 2026-10-05: childwelfare.gov, Mandatory Reporting of Child Abuse and Neglect, current through May 2023; confirm your own state's current statute and your district's rules].

What you need to know on day one:

- 1. Ask the school the five questions** in your Contact Card: Am I a reporter? What is the standard? Who do I report to, and how? How fast? Is my duty personal?
- 2. Your role is recognition and response.** You do not investigate, confront anyone, view images, search phones or counsel.
- 3. If a child tells you something hard,** use the First 10 Minutes: thank the child, say "This is not your fault. You are not in trouble," ask only what you need, be honest that you cannot keep it secret, do not view, copy,

forward or screenshot suspected sexual images of a minor, and **tell your mentor teacher or the designated safety contact right away**. Then follow the school's reporting policy together. Do not wait until you get back to campus. Your own duty may be personal and may not be satisfied by telling someone else [VERIFY your state].

4. **Document facts afterward** (exact words, date, time, who was told) on the school's form. Give nothing to the college except the fact that a disclosure happened if the school allows it. Do not put it in your journal or your field log.
5. **Look after yourself.** Tell the mentor teacher and the field office that you need a debrief. Use the care plan from Week 9. The college counseling center and 988 are available [CENTER, PHONE; VERIFIED 2026-10-05: 988lifeline.org].

04 The no-student-data rule

THE KIT'S RULE IS the same for candidates: **no student accounts and no student data, ever.**

- No student names, photos, video or audio recordings of students, or copies of student work leave the school. Your observation notes describe **teacher moves**, not students ("The teacher waited five seconds after the question"), and use no names or initials.
- Do not take or keep photos of students or their work. Do not post anything about your placement on social media.
- Exit tickets and any class tallies belong to the mentor teacher, stay at school, and follow the district's retention policy [VERIFY].
- Do not put any student information, field-placement detail or disclosure detail into a chatbot or any online tool. Follow the district's AI policy [VERIFY].
- Do not contact students by phone, text, email or social media. Communicate with families only through the school.
- Use school-approved devices and accounts only.
- If you accidentally record or keep something that identifies a student, tell your mentor and the field office the same day.

05 Supervised K-12 delivery

What you may teach. Standard-care lessons only (the list is in Assignments and Rubrics, Section 2). You may **not** teach telling-adult lessons, K-2 My Body Is Mine, the 6-8 and 9-12 lessons on grooming, pressure online, fakes that hurt, sextortion and image abuse, coercion in relationships, or the Plus trafficking lessons. Those need counselor involvement and, for the trafficking lessons, specialist review first [see the Counselor Heads-Up and Opt-Out Toolkit and the Florida crosswalk; VERIFY lesson numbers in your edition].

Approval chain (all in writing). Mentor teacher approves the lesson plan at least 3 school days ahead; the administrator knows the dates; the counselor is aware; the school sends any family notice its policy requires [Confirm your district's notification rules with district counsel].

Rules for the day.

- Your mentor teacher is **in the room** for the whole lesson. You are never alone with students, and you never meet a student alone behind a closed door.
- Use the lesson shape: Hook 2, Activity 8, Discuss 3, Takeaway 2. Say the three promises. Close with the open door.
- Say the group agreements and the pass card. Ask no student for a personal story. Use characters and cards.
- If a student starts to disclose: thank them, say "Let's talk about this in a moment, just us," and **hand to your mentor**. Do not continue the conversation alone. Your mentor and the counselor follow the First 10 Minutes and the school's policy. You write nothing about it except a sentence for your own reflection that contains no details.
- If a student seems upset, offer the pause, the quiet corner or the pass, and tell your mentor.
- If you run over, cut a round of practice. Keep the takeaway and the open door.

After the lesson. A 10-minute debrief with the mentor. Two glows and one grow. Your reflection (150 words) says what you tried, what happened in terms of teacher moves, and what you will change. Do not describe a student.

Day-of checklist.

- ☐ Plan approved; materials copied (no real personal data on any card or sheet)
- ☐ Counselor knows today's lesson and is reachable

- ☐ I know the school's reporting route and my mentor's phone extension
- ☐ Group agreements, pass card and the open door are in my plan
- ☐ My Contact Card is in my binder

06 Observation forms

6.1 OBSERVATION 1: HOW A TEACHER TALKS WITH STUDENTS ABOUT TECHNOLOGY (ABOUT 1.5 HOURS)

No names. Describe teacher moves only.

PROMPT	MY NOTES
What technology came up (a game, an app, a device rule)?	
How did the teacher respond: curious, judgmental, dismissive, anxious? Give the words used.	
Any use of the four reactions that end conversations (panic, punishment, lecture, minimizing)?	
Any use of the curiosity script (be curious, listen more than you talk, reflect back, open questions, offer do not impose)?	
One thing I will borrow. One question I want to ask the teacher.	

6.2 OBSERVATION 2: FUN, SAFE, SKILL-BASED (ABOUT 1.5 HOURS)

Use the rubric in the Peer Coaching and Observation Guide (Section 3) or Handout H13. Rate each look-for N (not yet), G (getting there) or Y (got it). Write **one glow only**. Do not add up the ratings or compare teachers.

LOOK-FOR	N, G OR Y	EVIDENCE (TEACHER MOVES)
FUN 1: within 2 minutes, most students are moving, talking or hands-on		
FUN 2: laughter or energy is present and kind		
FUN 3: every student has a role		
SAFE 1: no scare tactics, graphic detail or shaming		
SAFE 2: pass allowed; no personal experiences asked for		
SAFE 3: "never your fault" and "tell, no trouble" said aloud		
SAFE 4: a route to tell is named; calm close		
SKILL 1: one clear skill practiced by students		
SKILL 2: ends with the routine and one takeaway		
SKILL 3: praise for the Pause or the Tell, not for being right		

If the lesson is not a safety lesson, use the same look-fors for any lesson and note how a safety message would fit.

6.3 MENTOR TEACHER FORM FOR A SUPERVISED LESSON

ITEM	MENTOR'S NOTES
Plan approved on (date) and counselor aware	
Lesson shape kept (2, 8, 3, 2); one skill, one phrase, one gesture	
Language calm and shame-free; three promises said	
Every student practiced the skill at least twice	
Open door and a route to tell were given	
Typical moments handled (nervous laughter, worrying answer, a long personal story)	
Privacy kept; no student data taken	
One glow	
One grow	

07 Mentor teacher agreement (summary)

A mentor teacher agrees to:

- Be in the room for any lesson the candidate delivers, and available for planning (about 30 minutes before each lesson).
- Approve the plan in writing at least 3 school days ahead, and confirm that the counselor is aware.
- Keep all student information at school. Hold exit tickets and tallies; the candidate does not take them.
- Model calm, shame-free language and the school's reporting route, and take over any disclosure at once.
- Give two glows and one grow after each lesson, and complete the form in Section 6.3 and the dispositions evaluation in Section 9.
- Contact the field office if anything feels off.

08 Capstone workshop sites

THE CAPSTONE IS A workshop for **adults**: families, a PTA, a library or a community group. If children could be present (for example, a school event), the partner site must approve and have a minors-safety plan: two adults present, no one-to-one contact between a candidate and a child, and a site contact who knows the reporting route. The counselor partner or a named safety contact is present for the question-and-answer section. Bring a sign-in sheet that records first names only, if the site allows it, or no names at all. Collect only the anonymous two-minute short form [Confirm any survey or consent rules with the site and counsel; see the research folder privacy checklist if you plan to publish anything].

09 Dispositions evaluation (mentor teacher or site supervisor)

RATE EACH ITEM 1 (Beginning), 2 (Developing), 3 (Hackles-Ready) or 4 (Mentor-level) at the end of the placement.

DISPOSITION	RATING
Uses calm, shame-free language with learners and adults	
Protects privacy; no student data leaves the school	
Knows and follows the reporting route; asks when unsure	
Is reliable and punctual	
Takes feedback and acts on it	
Is honest about what they know and do not know	

A rating of 1 on the first three items needs a conversation with the field office before the placement continues.

10 When something goes wrong

- **A student discloses to you.** Section 3. Hand to your mentor at once.
- **You made a privacy mistake.** Tell the mentor and the field office the same day. Honest reporting is the expected response, not a punishment.
- **A lesson went badly.** That is what the debrief is for. Use the hotwash idea from the Concepts Lab (Demo 13): what happened, what helped, what we will change, no blame.
- **You feel unsafe or overwhelmed.** Step out, tell your mentor, and call the field office or the counseling center.
- **A conflict with the school.** Call the field office. You do not have to resolve it alone.

11 Field log

DATE	SITE	HOURS	ACTIVITY	MENTOR INITIALS

Total on-site hours: _____. Candidate signature and date: _____. Mentor signature and date: _____.

12 A one-page note you can give the school

FIELD NOTE

No. 1

Our college offers a course called "Teaching Digital Safety and Cybersecurity in K-12." Candidates observe, co-plan and deliver two supervised 15-minute lessons from the free Hackles kit in your school. The lessons are skills-based and avoid graphic detail. We collect no student data, and candidates do not take student names, photos or work. Your teacher is in the room, your counselor is informed, and candidates teach standard-care lessons only. Hackles has not been reviewed or approved by any state education agency. Questions: [FIELD OFFICE CONTACT].

This guide is educational guidance, not legal advice. Consult your institution's counsel on placement agreements, background checks, mandated-reporting duties and insurance.